MindBridge AI

Concept Note | IBM Bob Final Project | SDG 3

1. Project Overview

MindBridge AI is a lightweight digital wellbeing companion designed to make the first step toward emotional support easier for students and young adults. Users can complete a short mood check-in, describe what is on their mind, and receive a supportive response with practical, low-risk coping options such as paced breathing, grounding, journaling, or reaching out to a trusted person. The project focuses on early reflection and signposting—not diagnosis, therapy, or medical advice. The prototype uses a guided, transparent response flow and a safety-first escalation pathway for messages that suggest immediate danger. It clearly encourages professional support when distress is persistent or severe and displays relevant support resources. The prototype does not require a login and should not store personal chat messages by default. The first pilot would be tested with a small group of students and reviewed by a qualified counsellor or mental-health professional before any real-world deployment. Feedback would measure usability, perceived helpfulness, clarity of safety messaging, and whether users can find appropriate next steps.

2. Problem Statement

Many students and young adults experience stress, anxiety, loneliness, and academic pressure, but may hesitate to seek support because of stigma, cost, limited access, or uncertainty about where to begin.

3. Objectives

• Make check-ins approachable.
• Offer practical non-clinical coping exercises.
• Signpost users to trusted or professional support.
• Demonstrate privacy-conscious and safety-aware product design.

4. Target Users

College students and young adults; later, campus wellbeing teams and student-support services.

5. Proposed Features

• Mood check-in (1–5) and optional emotion.
• Guided supportive chat and next-step menu.
• Breathing, grounding and journaling tools.
• Safety-first signposting when immediate danger may be present.
• Responsive no-login prototype with clear limitations.

6. Proposed Technology

Python + Streamlit. Initial response logic is transparent and rule-based; no external API key is required. IBM Bob can be used to inspect, extend, test and refactor the project. Any future language-model integration requires safety and privacy evaluation.

7. Expected Outcomes

• Working web demonstration.
• Clear flow from check-in to coping step or resource.
• Lean Canvas, concept note, presentation and test plan.

8. Evaluation Plan

Use a small voluntary usability pilot with appropriate permission. Measure task completion, perceived helpfulness, resource discoverability and clarity of limitations. Avoid collecting clinical data or inferring diagnoses.

9. Safety, Ethics and Limitations

Safety and scope:
• MindBridge AI is not a diagnostic tool and does not replace a counsellor, doctor, or emergency service.
• It does not make clinical risk predictions or promise confidentiality beyond the actual system design.
• Users are encouraged not to enter identifying or highly sensitive information.
• If a user may be in immediate danger, the app urges them to contact local emergency services and a trusted person now.
• Any real deployment requires expert content review, privacy/security assessment, accessibility testing, and a documented escalation process.

10. Conclusion

MindBridge AI aims to lower the friction of taking a first step toward wellbeing. It is not a diagnostic or treatment system and must be reviewed by qualified professionals before real-world deployment.